Daniel Chechelnitsky

chechelnitskd — dchechel@cmu.edu — Google Scholar

Research Interests

translation technologies, machine translation, multilingual NLP, dialects, user perspectives

Education

Carnegie Mellon University & Instituto Superior Técnico — Pittsburgh, PA & Lisbon, Portugal
Doctor of Philosophy in Language and Information Technology — *Aug. 2024 – Present*
- Advisors: Giuseppe Attanasio, André Martins, & Maarten Sap

University of Michigan – Ann Arbor — Ann Arbor, MI
Master of Science in Computer Science and Engineering — *Aug. 2022 – Apr. 2024*
- Advisor: Nikola Banovic

Macalester College — Saint Paul, MN
Bachelor of Arts in Linguistics — *Aug. 2018 – May 2022*
- Advisor: Susan Fox

Experience

SULI Intern — Jun. 2022 – Aug. 2022
Argonne National Laboratory — *Lemont, IL*
- Replicated AUC results from MOLI and Velodrome model papers
- Optimized hyperparameter training of MOLI using Ray tune
- Presented findings at SULI Summer Research Showcase

DSI Summer Lab Intern — Jun. 2021 – Aug. 2021
The University of Chicago - Data Science Institute — *Chicago, IL*
- Built an accessible mobile app using Flutter framework that uses deep learning models trained on Kaggle datasets to predict prostate cancer, skin cancer, and heart failure risk
- Demo-ed app and presented poster at DSI Summer Lab and Macalester College 2021 Summer Research Showcases

Software Development Intern — Nov. 2020 – Apr. 2021
GogyUp — *Minneapolis, MN*
- Designed, programmed and integrated 2 different NLP frameworks successfully into a Smart Dictionary App from spaCy Python library
- Compared 2 other implementations of text processing APIs in Python
- Presented 12 weekly Google Analytics website traffic reports at company meetings

Publications

Ouvia: A User-centered Framework for Measuring Usability of Speech Translation in Real-World Communication Scenarios
Giuseppe Attanasio, Beatrice Savoldi, Daniel Chechelnitsky, Matteo Negri, Marine Carpuat, Maarten Sap, André F.T. Martins
EMNLP (Main), 2026

Locating Translation as a Craft in the Age of AI
Daniel Chechelnitsky, Sireesh Gururaja*, Seyi Olojo*, Giuseppe Attanasio, Wesley Hanwen Deng, Chrysoula Zerva, Maarten Sap
AIES, 2026

Empire Amplifier: Uncovering and Contesting the Prioritization of Colonial Content on Platforms Through Community-Informed Algorithmic Auditing
Nel Escher, Bakyt Yrysov, Ashley McDermott, Daniel Chechelnitsky, Hermela Benyam, Nikola Banovic
CSCW, 2026

***Making a Name for Myself*: On Academic Naming Policies and their Impact**
A Pranav, Vagrant Gautam, Martin Mundt*, Jordan Taylor*, Arjun Subramonian*, Franziska Sofia Hafner*, Daniel Chechelnitsky*, William Agnew*, Anne Lauscher*
FAccT, 2026 **[Best Paper Honorable Mention]**

Not Like Us, Hunty: Measuring Perceptions and Behavioral Effects of Minoritized Anthropomorphic Cues in LLMs
Jeffrey Basoah*, Daniel Chechelnitsky*, Tao Long, Katharina Reinecke, Chrysoula Zerva, Kaitlyn Zhou, Mark Díaz, Maarten Sap
FAccT, 2025

Rejected Dialects: Biases Against African American Language in Reward Models
Joel Mire*, Zubin Trivadi Aysola*, Daniel Chechelnitsky, Nicholas Deas, Chrysoula Zerva, Maarten Sap
NAACL (Findings), 2025

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant Jan. 2026 – Apr. 2026
Carnegie Mellon University *Pittsburgh, PA*

- Created and maintained course website for 11-711: Advanced Natural Language Processing
- Held office hours, facilitated Piazza forums, and graded assignments and exams

Graduate Student Instructor Aug. 2022 – May 2024
University of Michigan - Ann Arbor *Ann Arbor, MI*

- Led two lab sections weekly for EECS 281: Data Structures and Algorithms & EECS 403: Graduate Foundations of Data Structures and Algorithms
- Held office hours, organized review sessions, and facilitated Piazza forums, graded assignments and exams

Instructional Aide Jan. 2020 – May 2022
Macalester College *Saint Paul, MN*

- Held office hours, graded assignments, and assisted in course planning across 5 semesters for Data Structures, Core Concepts in CS, Theory of Computation, Computer Systems, and Computational Linear Algebra

Honors & Awards

- FAccT 2026 Best Paper Honorable Mention, 2026
- Computer Science Departmental Honors, Macalester College, 2022
- cum laude, Macalester College, 2022
- ASA DataFest 2021 Challenge Best Question Asked, 2021

Press

- WIRED Article (Empire Amplifier)
- University of Michigan Newsletter (Empire Amplifier)
- Globe.AI Article (Not Like Us, Hunty)
- IBM Article (Rejected Dialects)

Technical Skills

Languages: Java, Python, C++, C, SQL (SQLite/MySQL), Dart, Elixir, Swift, JavaScript, R, HTML
Other Tools: Google Cloud, PyTorch, Keras, Prolific